

## BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

### Can You Keep a Secret?

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Class: \_\_\_\_\_

Score: \_\_\_\_\_ / 14

#### NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - A possible benefit

| No. | Sentence                                                                                                       |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Keeping good news private can make someone feel more _____, especially when they intend to tell someone later. |
| 2   | A _____ is one example of something enjoyable that a person may plan never to disclose.                        |
| 3   | A surprise _____ is an example of news kept so that it can later be revealed.                                  |
| 4   | Revealing welcome news gives people a chance to share and _____ it with others.                                |
| 5   | A sense of _____ over one's emotions can make a positive secret energising.                                    |
| 6   | In some cultures, people may _____ a pregnancy announcement until they feel it is safe to share.               |
| 7   | In the early stages, a pregnancy secret may feel like a _____ to the person keeping it.                        |

#### 11 Which contrast introduces the discussion about keeping secrets?

- A People often value privacy, although sharing news can strengthen relationships.
- B People often see secrecy negatively, although some secrets may improve their lives.
- C People often keep secrets easily, although some news is difficult to protect.
- D People often enjoy surprises, although keeping them can make them anxious.

#### 12 According to the studies described, when might holding on to good news feel especially positive?

- A When the news concerns a person whom the listener already knows.
- B When the person expects the news to remain private indefinitely.
- C When the person intends to share the news with someone later.
- D When the person has already discussed the news with friends.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What distinguishes the two kinds of enjoyable secrets described by the researcher?**
- A Whether the person intends to reveal them eventually.
  - B Whether the news concerns a relationship or an object.
  - C Whether other people can guess the secret beforehand.
  - D Whether keeping the secret produces a sense of guilt.
- 14 **What effect does the presenter attribute to negative secrets?**
- A They can reduce the excitement of a planned surprise.
  - B They can make people less willing to discuss emotions.
  - C They can prevent good news from reaching other people.
  - D They can harm people and strain their relationships.
- 15 **Why is the location of the research raised in the discussion?**
- A It may limit how confidently the findings apply to other cultures.
  - B It explains why the study focused on marriage proposals.
  - C It shows that secrecy is understood similarly worldwide.
  - D It suggests that the results depend on the language spoken.
- 16 **What is the purpose of the example about delaying pregnancy news in some cultures?**
- A To show that early pregnancy news is usually a negative secret.
  - B To explain why researchers avoid asking about pregnancy.
  - C To explore whether cultural beliefs affect decisions to share good news.
  - D To show that all good news is best kept private until it is safe.
- 17 **How does the researcher tentatively contrast pregnancy secrets at earlier and later stages?**
- A People become less concerned about others' reactions as time passes.
  - B The same news can feel more comfortable to discuss at a later stage.
  - C The secret becomes positive only after everyone already knows it.
  - D Pregnancy news has a fixed emotional effect across cultures.